



Voller's dubious penalty — Germany vs Argentina, 1990 World Cup

Maradona found himself on the receiving end of some questionable refereeing decisions in the following edition, this time in the final as Argentina looked to defend its crown against West Germany.

The final, a dour affair in Rome, featured several questionable decisions from referee Edgardo Codesal. First, he did not award a penalty when Rudi Voller was hauled down in the Argentina box, and then gave Argentina's Pedro Monzon the dubious honour of becoming the first player to receive his marching orders in a World Cup final after a tackle on Jurgen Klinsmann.

The defining moment came with a little over five minutes to play. Voller was slipped into the channel, and defender Roberto Sensini stepped across the striker. As he did, Voller hit the floor, and though there was minimal contact, Codesal pointed to the spot to award a soft penalty.

Andreas Brehme tucked away the spot-kick, and after Gustavo Dezotti also received his marching orders for a frustrated act of violent conduct, West Germany celebrated its second World Cup title.



Schumacher escapes red — West Germany vs France, 1982 World Cup

West Germany goalkeeper Harald Schumacher's collision with France's Patrick Battiston remains one of the most sickening injuries suffered on a World Cup field. With the score level at 1-1 in the second half of the semifinal in Seville in 1982, Michel Platini lofted a ball through the West Germany defence for Battiston to run onto, and Schumacher came charging off his line to collect it.

Battiston got there first, but Schumacher's momentum was too much to control, and the keeper caught him with full force. Battiston was left unconscious, lost two teeth, and suffered damage to his back and ribs as a result, forcing him to be substituted.

It was a heavy, late challenge from the German keeper, undoubtedly worthy of a red card, and yet Charles Corver inexplicably awarded a goal-kick, letting Schumacher go unpunished. To make matters worse for the French, the match finished 3-3 after extra-time, and Schumacher saved two penalties in the shootout to take West Germany to a final against Italy.



(No) Golden Goal — Italy vs South Korea, 2002 World Cup

All the other entries on this list are singular incidents that pivoted the course of matches and tournaments. But the need for VAR in Italy and co-host South Korea's last-16 match in Rifu extended far beyond a single moment, as referee Byron Moreno drew the ire of an Italian side that felt hard done by.

The issues began five minutes in, when Moreno awarded South Korea a soft penalty for a shirt pull in the box. Ahn Jung-hwan saw his penalty saved by Gianluigi Buffon, and Christian Vieri soon headed in Francesco Totti's corner to give Italy the lead. Italy held on in a niggly contest until Seol Ki-hyeon swept home with seconds to spare to send the game to extra-time.

In the first half of the additional 30 minutes, with a Golden Goal set to decide victory, Totti turned in the box and went down under a challenge, only for Moreno to award him a second yellow card for diving. A short while later, Damiano Tommasi found himself through on goal, only to see the flag raised despite being clearly onside.

By the time Ahn swept home the winner, Italy seemed convinced that it had been the victim of a conspiracy to eliminate it. FIFA President Sepp Blatter later called the linesmen's performances a "disgrace," but it was all too late as South Korea moved on to reach the semifinals of the World Cup, while Italy headed home.